CHAPTER 01 | AROUND 2000-2007: FIVE DAY-SCHOOL YEARS, THEN TWO BOARDING HIGH-SCHOOL YEARS

Fiango

Football, friendship, unpaid school fees, and a gifted boy's growing determination to give his mother a better life.

Dramatic question What happens when a boy who can invent a solution to anything meets a problem he cannot talk his way out of?

Act I - Setup

Street football introduces Zino's wit, competitiveness, and temper. Luc and Gideon hear his outrageous stories about Grand-Chukuchuku, the man who achieves what nobody else can. Brief fantasy sequences make those boasts visible before returning us to the real game. The compound is a small society: two families, three single mothers, two bachelors, and three student tenants share the well and mango tree. The landlord's monthly collection of rent and electricity money turns money into a recurring presence. Zino's mother, a primary-school teacher, believes in him. His father died after a snake bite while spraying cocoa when Zino was two, so the loss enters through family history rather than a memory he owns.

Turning point: His imagination can win an argument, but the household's limits cannot be wished away.

Act II - Confrontation

The first five years of day school give Zino daily life with Luc and Gideon. His earlier primary-school fee exclusion can return as a clearly placed memory; the later high-school exclusion belongs at its actual date. Each June, the daytime vocational school called Professional School opens classrooms at night for day-school students to revise, study in groups, socialize, or escape home; show its temptations without claiming every student is distracted. Zino's four reported encounters with jungle justice occur during these Fiango years. At the end of the five years, he writes ten GCE Ordinary-Level subjects, from a possible maximum of eleven. Results are read on the radio, turning the wait into a shared public ordeal and the result into celebration.

Turning point: The first result opens a road forward, but it sends Zino farther from everything familiar.

Act III - Consequence

The final two high-school years move Zino to a remote village reached after a day of travel through mountains and valleys. Boarding school brings elite students, rich parents, white teachers and priests, rigid routine, bullying, and discipline. Zino witnesses students punished for jumping the fence to buy food; he is not the student jumping. At the end, he writes five GCE Advanced-Level subjects, the maximum and his university study area. His school has a 100% Advanced-Level pass rate, so Zino is not waiting in fear of failure; the radio reading of names and the celebration give the result its emotional force. He completes secondary school in 2007, but education still requires money.

Turning point: He has the qualification to continue, but the household still needs a way to pay.

CHAPTER 01 | DEVELOPMENT PAGE

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Fiango

At the beginning	At ten, Zino has completed primary school and lives with his mother in Fiango.
At the end	Secondary school is complete in 2007; his ambition now depends on finding a way to continue.

Three possible short episodes

1. Grand-Chukuchuku Never Loses

A football dispute introduces the imaginary hero and the real boy's difficulty accepting an unfavorable decision.

2. School Fees

At the remembered age, a fee exclusion interrupts academic confidence and changes the rhythm of an ordinary school day.

3. The Crowd

Zino witnesses a hard-R composite of jungle justice during the Fiango day-school years: an accusation becomes public violence. The episode shows the brutality directly and ends with the fear, silence, and moral damage left behind.

4. Results on Air

The GCE Ordinary-Level and Advanced-Level result days make the radio a public stage for dread, names, relief, joy, and celebration. Zino writes ten Ordinary-Level and five Advanced-Level subjects.

5. The Fence

Zino witnesses students punished after jumping the boarding-school fence to buy food. The episode makes clear that he does not jump, while showing how hunger, fear, and discipline shape the whole dormitory.

Memory prompts

1. Which day school did you attend with Luc and Gideon, what were your ten Ordinary-Level subjects, and what is one defining memory of Luc, Gideon, Elianne, or Miss Mukete?

2. Who told you the story of your father's death, and what details are most important for that family-history scene?

3. What did Professional School mean in your day school, which exam was it for, and what is one evening or jungle-justice incident you remember most clearly?

4. What was the boarding school's name, how did you travel there, what were your five Advanced-Level subjects, and who was present around the radio when the results were read?

Grand-Chukuchuku motif Grand-Chukuchuku is playful and spectacular: imaginary victories contrast with ordinary limits.

Details still open: Five day-school years end in ten Ordinary Levels; two boarding years end in five Advanced Levels and radio results. Zino witnessed the fence punishments.